

THE CENTURY ANSWER

百年应答 · Bǎinián Yìngdá

Jingzhang Railway Heritage Park · Conceptual Urban Design Album for the AI Innovation Corridor (Reference Scheme)

In 1909 the Jingzhang Railway answered a century question: can Chinese engineers build their own railway? Today, beside the 9-km park the railway left behind, 2,000+ AI firms are answering a new one: can China build its own AI? This scheme unrolls the park as an open answer sheet — citizens crouch to count the spikes of self-reliant innovation.

9 km

Total length of the
heritage-park spine
(approx.)

1,141.3 ha

Submitted boundary
11,412,825 sqm
(metrics.json)

3

Key design areas:
192.1 / 104.3 / 72.0
ha (official figures)

46

Planned Phase-II gates
(subject to actual
completion)

~70 / 450k

Communities along the
line / residents
served (public data)

122

Registered LLMs in
Haidian (district govt
figure, Feb 2026)

Tracks: jingzhang-heritage-narrative / youth-friendly-public-space / ai-origin-community
Scenarios: ai-cultural-guide / ai-traffic-walkability / robot-delivery-low-speed / enterprise-service-copilot / ai-health-service-navigation

All spatial and development content herein is a conceptual proposal / reference scheme for professional refinement. It is not a government-approved conclusion and contains no binding figures on FAR, building height, road red lines, or demolition decisions. All facts cite public sources.

Contents & Executive Snapshot

Key information of the whole scheme is compressed into the first three pages

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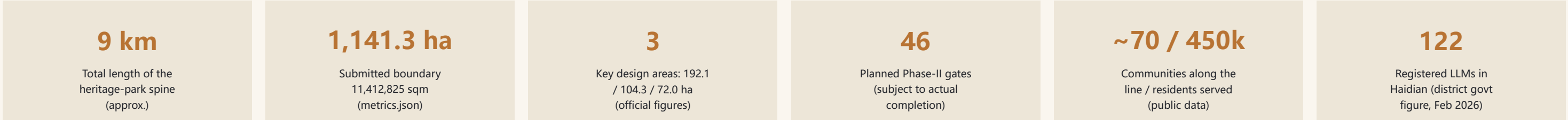
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Three belts, one spine: Question — Answer — Reading

- Question · Jingzhang heritage belt: the 1909 question (Zhan Tianyou, Tsinghuayuan Station, the herringbone line)
- Answer · AI innovation belt: firms and models answer — one bronze rail spike per registered Haidian LLM (122 at opening, district govt figure)
- Reading · Urban AI-life belt: citizens count spikes, hear the Answer Bell, watch roadshows; 46 Answer Gates reach ~70 communities
- Spine · 9-km answer scroll: South asks (Dazhongsi Bell Gate) — Middle answers (AI Origin) — North leaps (Zhongzhi herringbone bridge node)

Signature mechanisms (0-1 hits in full-corpus collision search)

- Spike Belt: one registered LLM = one bronze spike engraved with [registration event + date]; decoupled from company survival; new spikes each annual season = a living memorial
- Tap-a-Spike: NFC/QR opens the model's public demo or a guide agent (linked to Beijing's agent-development measures)
- Answer Bell: a newly cast bell beside the 1733 Dazhongsi great bell — cultural dialogue only; the heritage bell is never struck
- March-25 separation: Tsinghuayuan Station hosts only a non-commercial memorial open day; all commercial events move to Dazhongsi / Zhongzhi
- 46 Answer Gates x ~70 adopting communities: the century question outside, today's answer inside (per Phase-II planning, subject to completion)
- Gap Lounges (connect first) + robot ramp = accessibility ramp + City Evolution Archive + youth curation rights + service stations + three auditable lists



Design Basis & Three-tier Scope

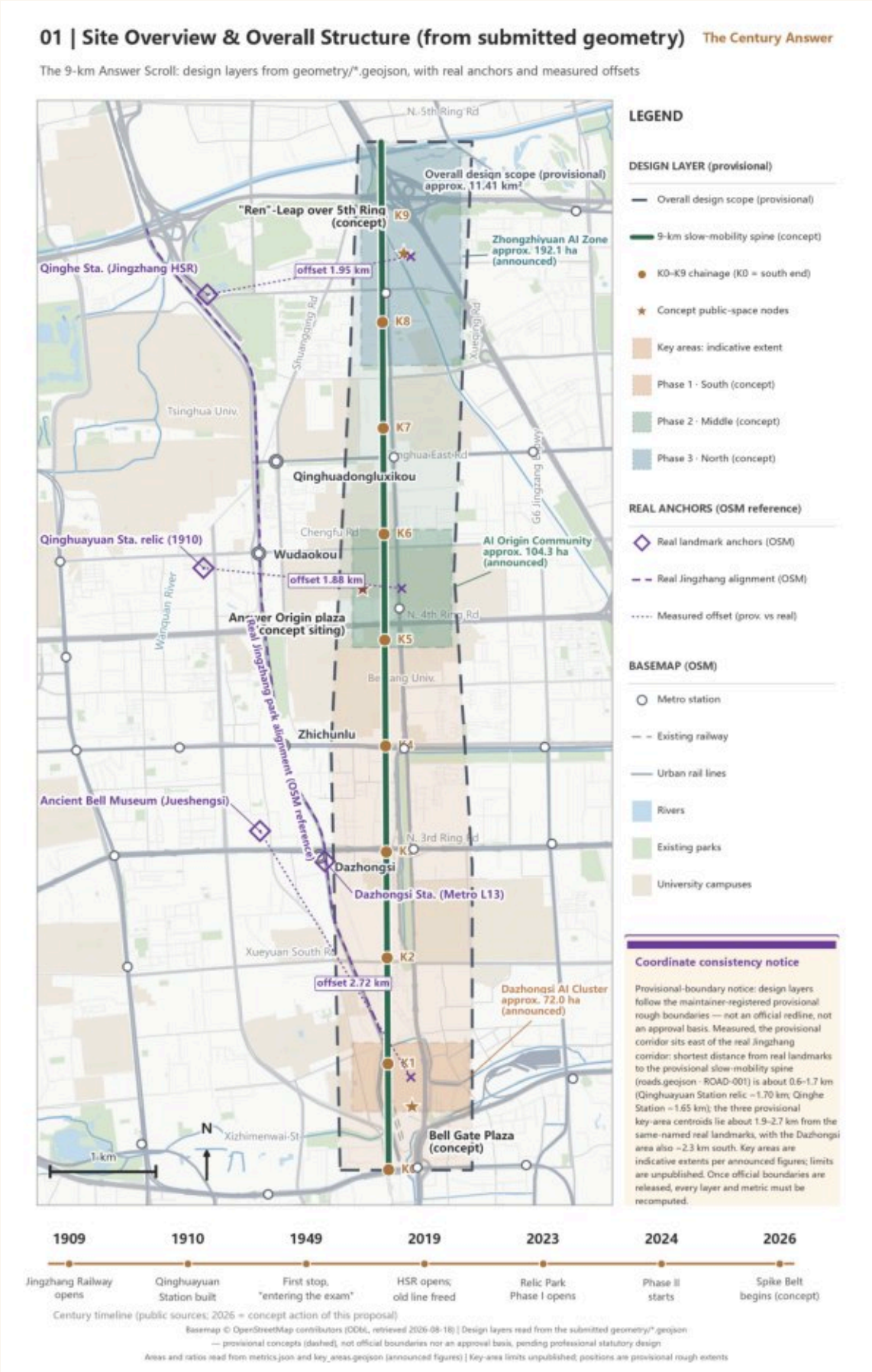
Mapped to all six brief deliverables · areas follow metrics.json and official public figures

Basis

- The client brief (six deliverables: concept design / brand narrative / AI scenarios / key-area design / metrics compliance / bilingual delivery) and the site-package data
- Public policy: Beijing's measures on accelerating agent-led AI development
- Beijing Statistical Communique: 209 registered LLMs citywide, about one-third of the national total
- Haidian public fundamentals: 2,000+ AI firms; core industry scale near RMB 360bn; 26 unicorns (70% of Beijing); 12,300 AI scholars (80%+ of Beijing); ~5,000 PCT filings/yr (official URLs in sources.json)
- Tsinghuayuan Station records: built 1910, name inscribed by Zhan Tianyou; first Beijing stop of the CPC leadership's 1949 'entering the examination' journey (Mar 25); reopened after restoration Mar 25, 2023 (tsinghua.org.cn)

Three-tier scope

- Tier 1 · Full corridor: ~9 km of heritage park; ~70 communities, ~450k residents, 10+ universities, 40+ research institutes along the line
- Tier 2 · Submitted boundary: 11,412,825 sqm (approx. 1,141.3 ha; metrics.json, high confidence)
- Tier 3 · 3 key design areas (official areas): Zhongzhi Park 192.1 ha / AI Origin Community 104.3 ha / Dazhongsi 72.0 ha
- Status anchors: Phase I (2.4 km, 16.8 ha) opened June 2023 with 5 new east-west links; Phase II started Dec 2024 — 46 gates are a planning figure, subject to completion



Site Diagnosis

A city halved by the railway — and a park growing back along it

- A century of severance: the operating railway cut the city in two for over 100 years; with the rail undergrounded, a 9-km linear void is released — stitching is the first task
- Gaps remain: several crossings are still unconnected; the authorities have published a mobility-optimization approach — this scheme responds gap-by-gap with conceptual connection strategies (connect first), then layers scenarios on top
- Phase I open: 2.4 km / 16.8 ha (June 2023) proves the linear park works and hosts all test-and-verify scenarios — nothing depends on unbuilt space
- Industry present: the corridor sits in Haidian's AI heartland — 2,000+ firms, 26 unicorns, 12,300 scholars — yet park and industry barely sense each other day to day
- Culture present: Tsinghuayuan Station and other centennial relics sit inside the belt, but no narrative device links the 1909 question to today's answers
- Conclusion: the scarcest resource is not space but a legible 'answer-sheet structure' for citizens, firms and visitors — exactly what this concept supplies

Figure discipline

The main text uses the district government figure of 122 registered LLMs (as of Feb 2026); Beijing Daily's February figure of 128 and the Capital Window April figure of 130 reflect reporting-time differences and are footnoted honestly. The citywide total of 209 is in the Beijing Statistical Communique.



Overall Concept: Naming, Narrative & Logo Direction

A brand that carries worldwide: The Century Answer

Naming logic

'The Century Answer' locks 1909 (the century question on the eve of the Jingzhang Railway) and 2026 (AI answering in progress) into one question-and-answer pair. Full-corpus collision search: the names 'Century Answer / Answer Bell / Spike Belt' score 0-1 hits and are ownable; the herringbone symbol scores 265 hits, spike imagery 29, 'examination journey' 26, bell-striking 26 — these are public heritage vocabulary over which no exclusivity is claimed; differentiation lives at the mechanism level (KPI-bound living spikes, the annual day, Answer Gates, the Evolution Archive, curation rights).

Logo direction (verbal brief; design to be refined)

- Primary motif: spike cross-section x answer sound-ring — the circular top of a bronze spike with radiating rings that read as bell sound and speech bubble at once
- Alternate: an abstracted herringbone skeleton
- Hard collision constraints: a competing entry is named 'Ren-Line' with a herringbone logo, and a 'spike x cursor' composition is already taken — the primary must avoid both
- The logo carries a version number and evolves annually with the City Evolution Archive (a visual of 'learning, thinking, evolving')

Three design axioms

- Record facts, endorse no firm: spikes carry [registration event + date] only, decoupled from company survival — exit logic is built in
- Auditability first: LLM registration counts are in the Beijing Statistical Communique — the most auditable urban KPI on site; three lists (registrations / open source / open scenarios) published yearly in the multilingual Century Answer Report
- Strictest red-heritage boundary: the Mar-25 open day at Tsinghuayuan Station has no corporate naming, no commercial roadshow, no spike ceremony; commerce and red narrative are never coupled



Narrative base: three belts, one spine

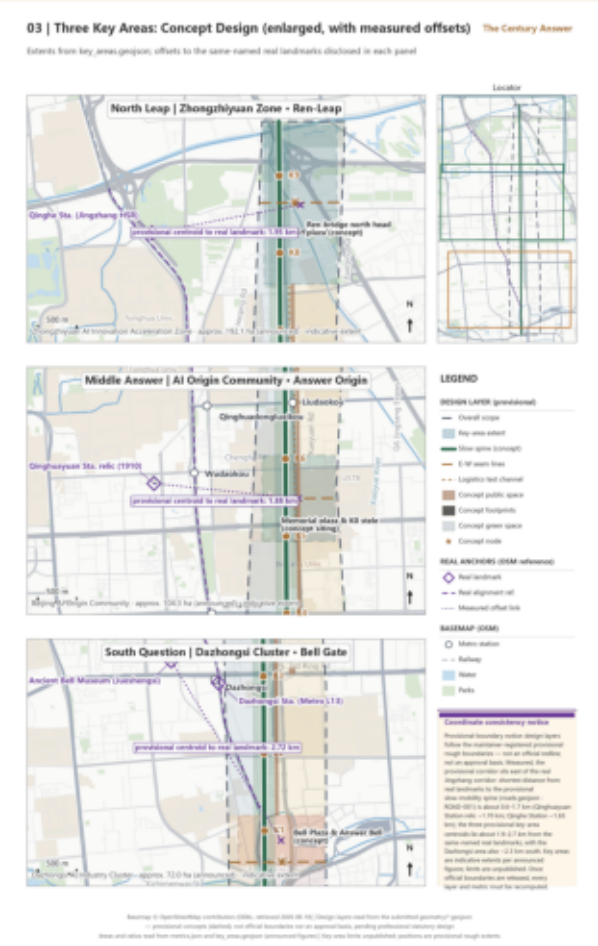
Spatial Structure

A 9-km answer-scroll spine; 46 Answer Gates reach ~70 communities east and west

- Three reaches of the spine: South asks (Dazhongsi 72.0 ha = Bell Gate; a newly cast Answer Bell and Bell Plaza stitching the metro station's four quadrants) — Middle answers (AI Origin Community 104.3 ha; Kilometre-Zero marker concept siting beside Tsinghuayuan Station, Spike Belt origin, low-disturbance campus stitching) — North leaps (Zhongzhi Park 192.1 ha; a herringbone footbridge concept node over the 5th Ring plus Qinghe blue-green space)
- East-west permeation: 46 Answer Gates (Phase-II planning figure, subject to completion), each an 'opened exam sheet' — the century question outside, today's answer inside; one adopting community per gate
- Four landmarks (all conceptual): Dazhongsi Answer Bell & Bell Plaza / Tsinghuayuan Station Century Answer Hall (answer book + Kilometre Zero beside the protected building, siting subject to heritage consultation) / the herringbone footbridge over the 5th Ring (concept node, no engineering conclusions; its screen updates three figures per the statistical release cycle — never 'real-time') / the Kilometre-Zero spike
- Connect first, then stay: gap-by-gap conceptual connection strategies answer the official mobility-optimization approach before scenarios are layered on

The one-day 'reading the answers' route

Bell Gate (hear one strike) → north along the Spike Belt (count and tap three spikes) → Gap Lounge (leave feedback) → Tsinghuayuan Station (read the inscribed name) → service station (pick up the report digest) → herringbone leap (read three figures) → City Evolution Archive (watch the scheme itself being graded). Every stop has one doable action; the red-heritage stop sits mid-route, not at the climax.

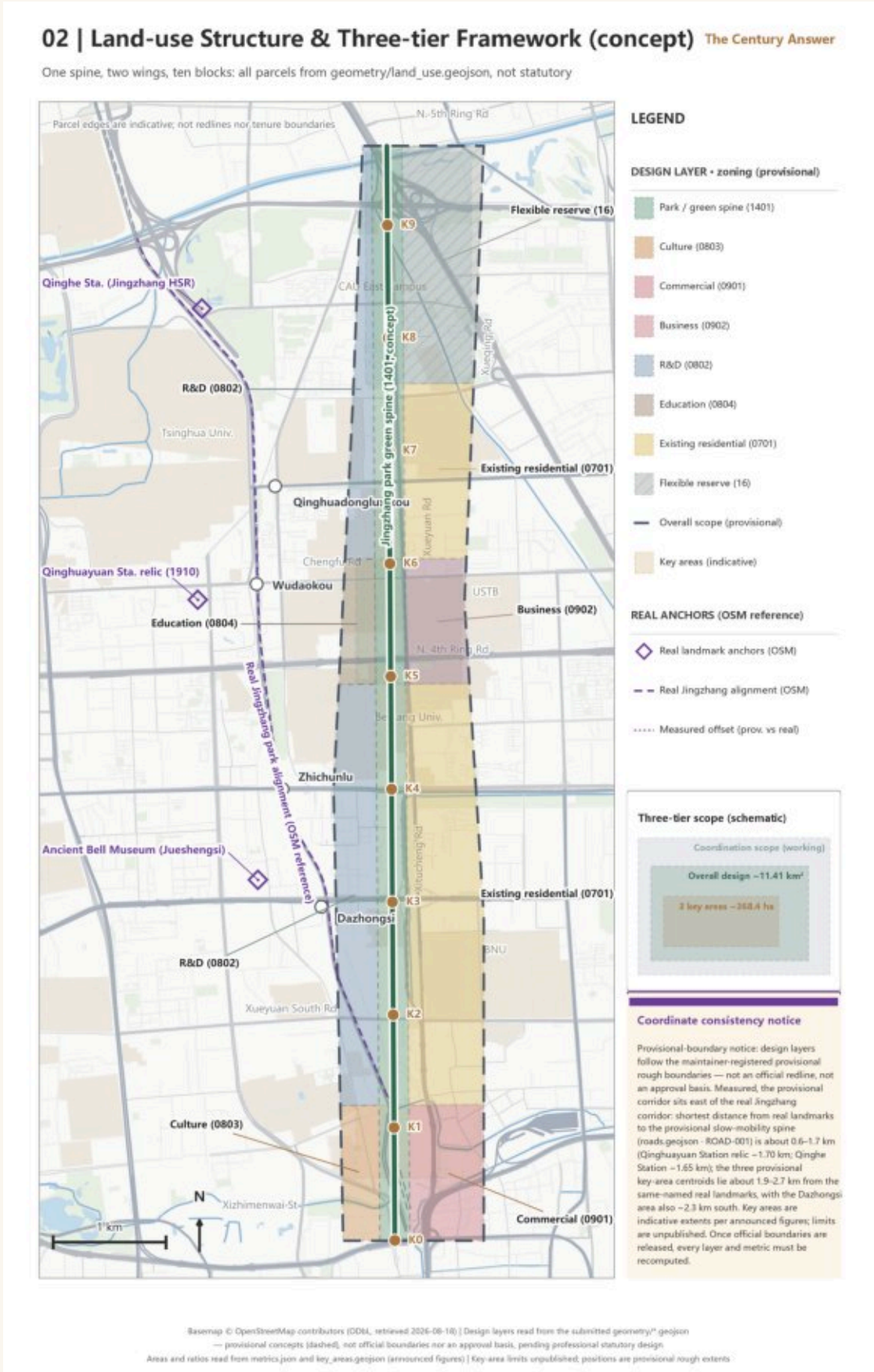


Three key areas (official areas)

Land Use & Renewal Strategy

Conceptual guidance only — no demolition or intensity conclusions

- Principles: light-touch, reversible, reuse-first — new functions occupy existing buildings and under-used space; no new stand-alone buildings are assumed
- Element service stations: sited in under-used spaces on both park flanks (policy advice / registration coaching / matchmaking — never on-the-spot approval); the closer to the park, the more shared — manufacturing reasons to cross east-west
- Flagship stations suggested near the Dazhongsi and Zhongzhi reaches; the demo-access test desk in Zhongzhi reuses existing floorspace (conceptual)
- Land ledger (metrics.json): submitted boundary 11,412,825 sqm; building footprint 3,125 sqm; green ratio 25.0%; public-space ratio 1.9%; FAR is unknown — official controls are not public and this scheme does not guess
- Sequencing (conceptual): Phase I's open 16.8 ha hosts all tests first; each Phase-II segment activates as it completes (46 gates subject to completion); no critical path depends on unapproved items

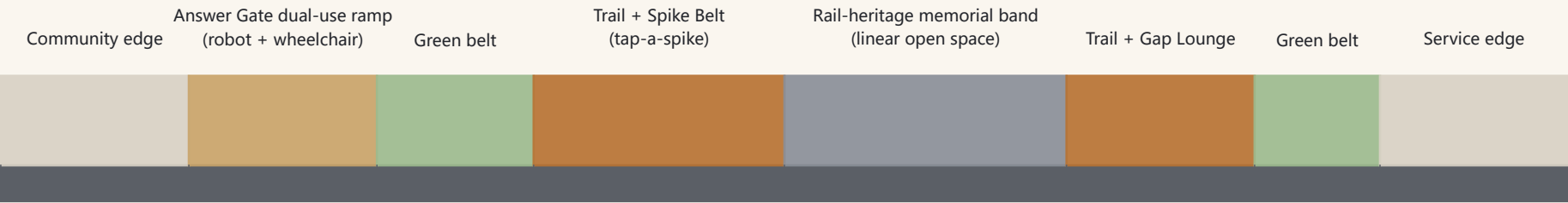


Land-use structure guidance (conceptual)

Mobility & Robot-corridor Section

Connect first, then stay: gaps before scenarios

- Gap Lounges: gap-by-gap conceptual connection strategies (answering the official mobility-optimization text); each connected space gets seating, canopy, info screen and water point, doubling as a feedback station
- Robot ramp = accessibility ramp: one retrofit, two users — delivery robots and wheelchairs share the ramp at all 46 gates; 'wheelchair first / mandatory yield' is a hard pass condition with accessibility as veto
- Test siting: a low-speed test loop inside Phase I's open 16.8 ha (physical bollards, safety marshal, peak-hour avoidance; a test proposal, not approved operation)
- Four-quadrant stitching: pedestrian flows around Dazhongsi metro station stitched through Bell Plaza (conceptual; mobility design to be professionally refined)
- Data boundary: no facial recognition, no individual tracking; robot perception data is de-identified at the edge, keeping anonymous event logs only



Conceptual section: functional bands only — no width, red-line or level figures; to be refined by professional teams



Mobility and blue-green systems (conceptual)

Blue-green & Public Space

Qinghe & Xiaoyue River: turning answers into daily life

- Ledger (metrics.json): green ratio 25.0%, public-space ratio 1.9% within the submitted boundary (medium confidence); official green-system planning prevails
- The Qinghe blue-green space meets the herringbone-bridge concept node to form the northern open-space climax (no engineering conclusions)
- The Xiaoyue River wing is the community outlet of scenarios: first health-navigation corners, community co-creation training, and priority assessment of community delivery extensions for robots that pass testing (all conceptual)
- A 10-piece public-space component kit: bronze spike / Answer Gate set / Gap Lounge furniture / info post / sound-wave paving / station module / dual-use ramp / curation plot / signed plaque / plain plaza
- Youth curation rights: each quarter a fixed share of plots is curated by student teams from 10+ universities along the line, with signed plaques; the events calendar follows the academic year (Sept departure / March roadshow season / June graduation + youth spike rite)
- City Evolution Archive: a public archive device beside the Spike Belt keeping the scheme's iteration history and public feedback — 'learning, thinking, evolving' becomes a loop

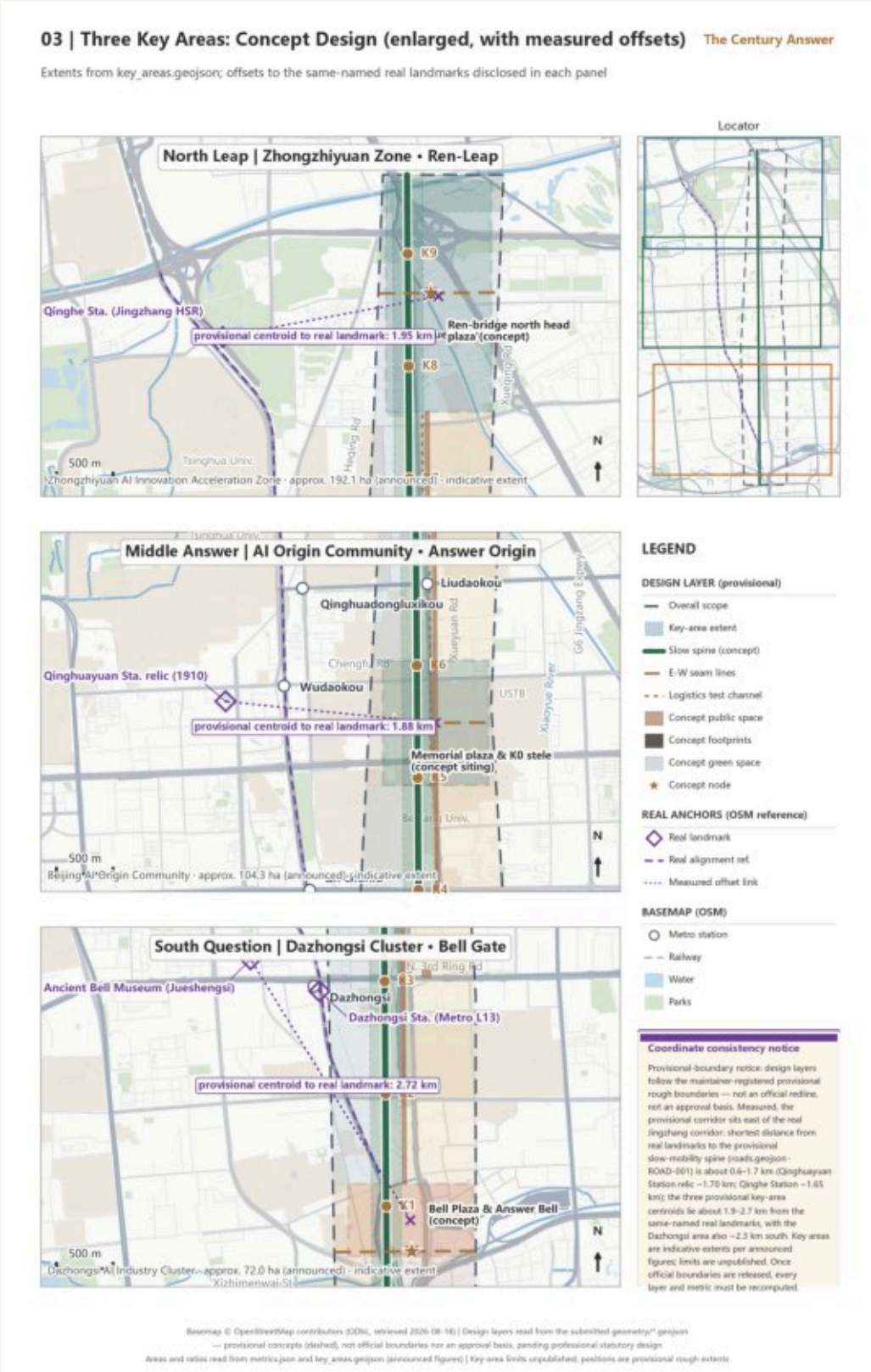


Blue-green and public-space systems (conceptual)

Key Area 1 • Dazhongsi (72.0 ha) • The Bell Gate

South asks: the city's ceremonial gate

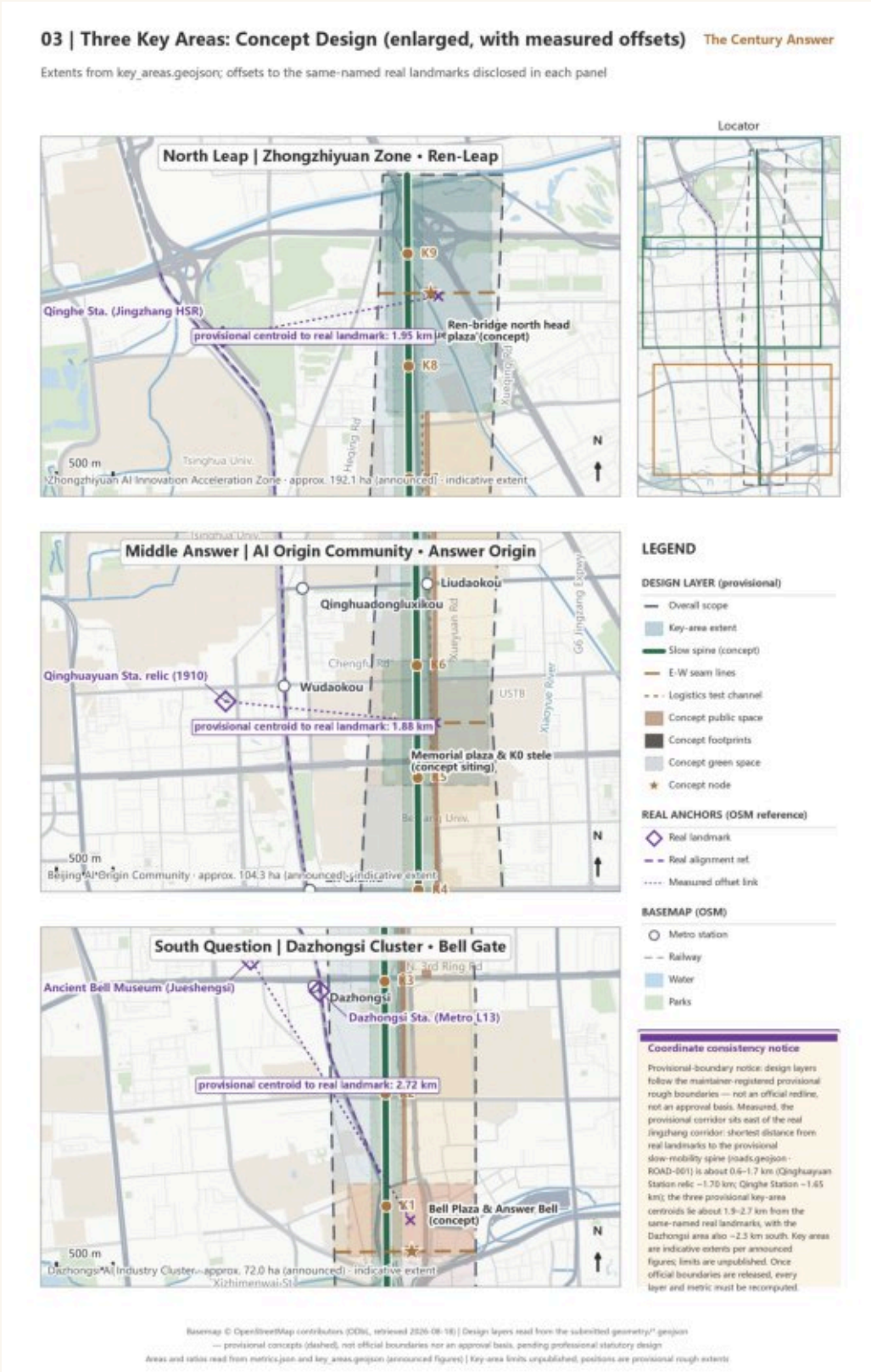
- The Answer Bell (honest wording): a newly cast bell beside the 1733 great bell of Dazhongsi, in cultural dialogue with the Ancient Bell Museum — never described as striking the heritage bell
- Bell mechanism: a firm in the belt completes LLM registration or an IPO, then strikes the bell once — industrial milestones gain a civic rite
- Bell Plaza: stitches the four pedestrian quadrants of Dazhongsi metro station (conceptual); four 'sound-wave paths' each carry a light info post
- Scenarios hosted: four-quadrant walking assistant (ai-traffic-walkability) / flagship registration-coaching Copilot station (enterprise-service-copilot) / March roadshow season and crowd-flow stress test (ai-traffic-walkability)
- Boundary: commercial roadshows and spike ceremonies happen here — never coupled with the red heritage of Tsinghuayuan Station



Key Area 2 • AI Origin Community (104.3 ha) • The Origin

Middle answers: the Spike Belt counts from here

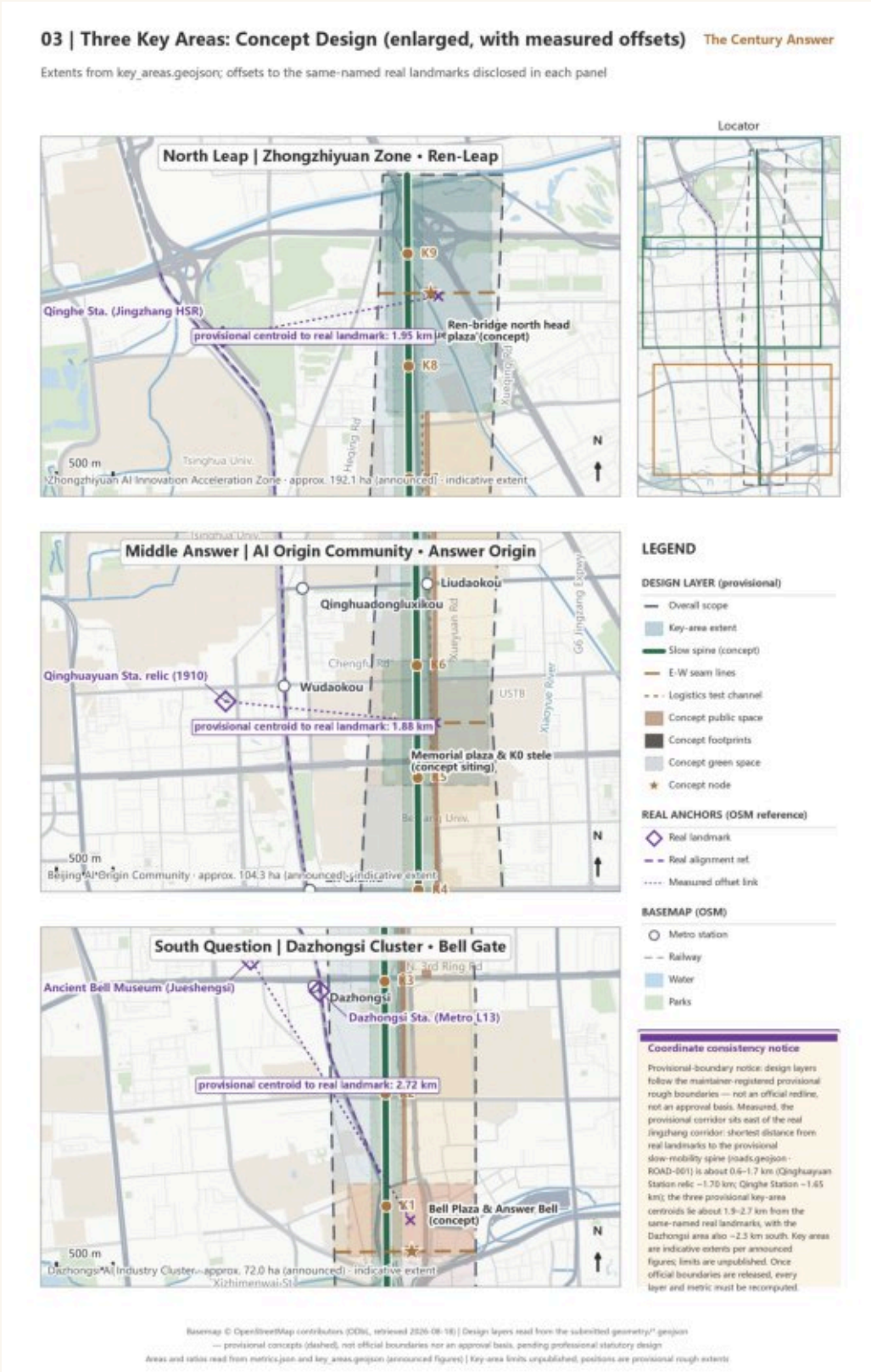
- Tsinghuayuan Station 'Century Answer Hall': not one brick of the protected building is touched; the answer book and Kilometre-Zero marker beside it are concept sitings subject to heritage-authority consultation (protection-zone GIS is missing — stated honestly)
- Spike Belt origin: Spike No. 0 tells the 1909 opening of the Jingzhang Railway; 122 spikes at opening per the district government figure (as of Feb 2026; figure differences footnoted)
- The Mar-25 memorial open day tells only three moments (station built 1910 / first Beijing stop of the 1949 'examination' journey on Mar 25 / restored and reopened Mar 25, 2023); no corporate naming, no commercial roadshow, no spike ceremony
- Low-disturbance campus stitching: the university edge favours slow permeation, with no high-volume event facilities (conceptual)
- Scenarios hosted: Tap-a-Spike (ai-cultural-guide) / open-day booking and storytelling service (ai-cultural-guide)



Key Area 3 • Zhongzhi Park (192.1 ha) • The Herringbone Leap

North leaps: toward the next question

- The herringbone footbridge over the 5th Ring: a pedestrian-bridge concept node reading as the character 'ren' (人) from above, answering the official call for 'an iconic node over the ring road' — explicitly a concept node with no engineering conclusions
- Its deck screen shows three figures (Haidian AI firms / registered LLMs / AI scholars) updated per the statistical release cycle — never 'real-time'
- Qinghe blue-green space: the northern open-space climax, joining waterfront slow mobility (conceptual)
- Scenarios hosted: LLM demo access-test desk (enterprise-service-copilot, in existing floorspace) / event-day corridor stress test (ai-traffic-walkability) / community-extension assessment of delivery robots after tests pass (robot-delivery-low-speed, permits prerequisite)
- Mechanisms hosted: a key youth-curation plot (the bridge viewing platform); all access and exit records public and archived in the Evolution Archive



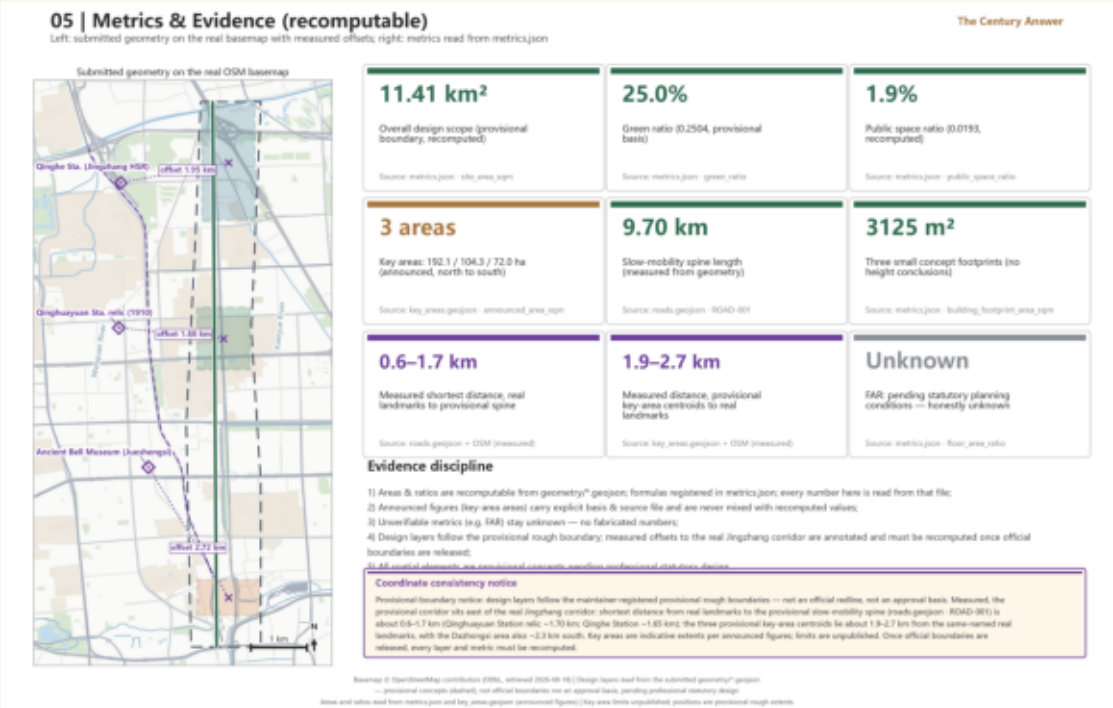
Metrics & Compliance Summary

Figures identical to metrics.json · 'unknown' is a legitimate final state

Metric	Value	Status / confidence	Source
Site area	11,412,825 sqm (approx. 1,141.3 ha)	known / high	geometry/site_boundary.geojson
Building footprint	3,125 sqm	known / medium	geometry/buildings.geojson
Green ratio	25.0%	known / medium	geometry/green_space.geojson
Public-space ratio	1.9%	known / medium	geometry/public_space.geojson
Floor area ratio	unknown (official controls not public; no guess)	unknown	planning_limits.json missing
Key-area count	3	known / high	geometry/key_areas.geojson

Compliance points

- Each scenario card maps to a scenario category named in the client brief — AI+transport / healthcare / education / law / living services, robotics, autonomous driving, unmanned delivery — plus the three concepts of AI culture, AI society and AI city; all eight categories and all three concepts are covered. Track names are the proposal's own and do not impersonate official codes
- Wording discipline: everything is 'conceptual / reference / for professional refinement'; no FAR, height, red-line or demolition conclusions; FAR honestly marked unknown
- Privacy red lines: zero added surveillance, no facial recognition or individual tracking, L1/L2/L3 data tiers, human final review, stoppable and reversible
- Red-heritage boundary: a dedicated chapter; the Mar-25 open day is the scheme's only red-narrative touchpoint, run under the strictest boundary
- Fact discipline: no fabricated firm lists, investments, output values or policy promises; every figure carries a public source (sources.json); registration-figure differences (122/128/130) footnoted honestly



Risks & Pending Inputs

Stating uncertainty openly is part of this scheme's credibility

- Heritage-zone GIS missing: every siting near Tsinghuayuan Station is a 'concept siting subject to heritage-authority consultation'; outcomes may move the Kilometre-Zero marker and answer book
- Phase-II uncertainty: 46 gates is a planning figure; Answer Gate and ramp counts follow actual completion; mechanism design does not depend on the exact number
- Registration-figure dynamics: 122 (district govt, Feb 2026) / 128 (Beijing Daily, Feb) / 130 (Capital Window, Apr) are reporting-time differences; opening-day spike count follows the official figure current at the ceremony
- FAR and regulatory controls unknown: official controls are not public and this scheme does not guess; professional teams will verify once provided
- The herringbone bridge is a concept node: a crossing over the 5th Ring requires multi-disciplinary engineering review; this scheme contains no engineering conclusions
- Tests require permits: robot testing and demo access are proposals, not approved operations; all are conditional on the relevant permits

Pending-input checklist

- Official regulatory controls (incl. FAR) and formal land boundary
- Heritage-protection-zone vectors and consultation opinions for Tsinghuayuan Station
- Phase-II gate completion schedule
- Mobility and accessibility professional verification
- Public-participation and community-adoption procedure design
- Bell casting and acoustic assessment (professional stage)

September handover stance

This album shares one source of truth with the main text, metrics.json, sources.json and geometry; the planning institute can continue directly from the pending-input checklist without reworking the concept layer.